

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A J 10 2

♣ K 9

♠ A 5

♥ K Q 10 9 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ Q J 4



♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 6

♦ 8 5 3

♣ A 10 7 3 2

♠ K 7 6 3

♥ J 4 2

♦ 9 7 4

♣ 8 6 5

NORTH has 18 points and a 5-card ♥ suit. This is a good hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has three ♥s which is adequate support. But SOUTH only has 4 points which is not strong enough to respond. So SOUTH passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

All Pass

1♥ by North

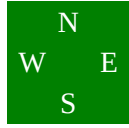
Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 2
 ♥ K 5 4 3
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ 9 8 3 2

♠ A 3
 ♥ Q 10
 ♦ Q J 3 2
 ♣ 10 7 6 5 4



♠ Q J 9 6 4
 ♥ A 9
 ♦ K 7 4
 ♣ K Q J

♠ 10 7 5
 ♥ J 8 7 6 2
 ♦ A 10 9 5
 ♣ A

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠	
All Pass			
3 ♠ by East			

EAST has 17 points counting 1 extra for the fifth ♠. This is a middle-range hand with five ♠s. So he opens 1 ♠.

WEST only has 7 points, 6 in high cards and one more for the doubleton ♦. But she does have three ♠s, so she can respond 2 ♠.

Since EAST is middle-range, he makes one more try by bidding 3 ♠.

If WEST had 9 or 10 points she would now bid 4 ♠ - but with 7 she passes.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 3

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q 10 7

♣ A 10 9 3

♠ Q 7 5

♥ K J 7 4

♦ J 9 4 2

♣ J 8



♠ 10

♥ A Q 10 5 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ K 7 6 2

♠ A J 9 6 4 2

♥ 8 3

♦ A 6

♣ Q 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

With 8 points, NORTH is not strong enough to open the bidding.

SOUTH has 13 points, barely meeting the minimum for a 1-opening. Note that the fifth and sixth ♠ each added 1 point to his count. He opens 1 ♠.

Although NORTH passed originally, she must respond to SOUTH's opening bid. Since she has three ♠s she raises to 2 ♠.

In light of NORTH's weak response SOUTH passes.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K
♥ Q J 8 6 4 2
♦ K Q 3
♣ 7 5

♠ 9 8 3 2

♥ A 3

♦ J 6 5 4 2

♣ A 4

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♠ J 6 5

♥ K 10 7 5

♦ A 8

♣ 9 8 6 2

♠ Q 10 7 4

♥ 9

♦ 10 9 7

♣ K Q J 10 3

West

1♥

3♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♥

4♥

South

Pass

WEST has 17 points and six ♥s. This is a mid-range 1♥ opening bid.

With 9 points, (1 for the doubleton), EAST raises to 2♥.

WEST's hand is worth one more try. He invites with 3♥.

EAST had a strong 2♥ raise, considering that she might have only had 6 points. So she carries on to 4♥.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 8

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 3

♣ J 7 3 2

♠ 10 9 2

♥ A K 5 4 2

♦ 8 5

♣ A K Q



♠ K 5 3

♥ 9 8

♦ 10 9 7 6 2

♣ 10 6 4

♠ 7 6 4

♥ Q 7 6 3

♦ A J 4

♣ 9 8 5

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

NORTH opens 1♥ with 17 points and five ♥s.

SOUTH, with 7 points and four trumps raises to 2♥.

NORTH has a mid-range hand, good enough to invite SOUTH to bid the game.

Too bad, but SOUTH is too weak to accept any invitations.

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 3
♥ 9 8 5 3
♦ 8 6 4 3
♣ 9 2

♠ Q 9 2

♥ 10 6

♦ K Q 2

♣ K 10 8 7 5



♠ K J 8 7 4

♥ K 7 2

♦ A 9 5

♣ A Q

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q J 4

♦ J 10 7

♣ J 6 4 3

WEST has a terrible hand, and naturally passes.

EAST, however, has a nice 18 points and opens 1♠.

WEST still has a terrible hand, and passes again. You need at least 6 points to respond to an opening one bid.

West

Pass

All Pass

1♠ by East

North

Pass

East

1♠

South

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 2
 ♥ 8 6 5 3 2
 ♦ J 8 7
 ♣ K Q 9

♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ A 7



♠ A 8

♥ J 10 9

♦ A 10 3

♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q J 5 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ J 8 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

SOUTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

NORTH has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣. It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠.

SOUTH cannot bid game yet, after all, NORTH could have as few as 6 points. But she can continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that NORTH actually has 9 or 10 points.

NORTH comes through with 4 ♠.

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 6
♥ K J 8 5 2
♦ A 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ Q 10 9

♥ 10 3

♦ Q 9 8 5

♣ K 9 7 2

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♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ K 6 2

♣ A Q 3

♠ A 5 4 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 3

♣ J 10 6 4

West

1♥

All Pass

3♥ by West

North

Pass

East

3♥

South

WEST has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1♥.

EAST has 11 points and good ♥ support so she jumps to 3♥.

WEST knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

Board 9

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 9 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A K Q 7 2

♦ K 6

♣ 10 9 5



♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 5 4 2

♣ K 6 2

♠ Q J

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ Q J 7

SOUTH has 11 points and she should pass.

NORTH has a minimum 1♥ opening, 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3♥.
(This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but NORTH can add and he knows the total points will be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 6 2
♥ K Q 7 5
♦ 8 3
♣ 10 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ J 9 8

♦ A K 6 2

♣ J 8 3



♠ K Q 10 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

♠ 4

♥ 10 6 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ K Q 9 5 2

EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠.

EAST passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. WEST can have a maximum of 10 points, which would only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by East

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8
♥ A 7 3 2
♦ Q J 4
♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2



♠ J 10

♥ 10 9 6 4

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points SOUTH should open 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

SOUTH adds: her 16 plus NORTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

♣ K J 3

♠ 9 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4 3

♣ 7 4 2



♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6

WEST has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal WEST will open 1♠.

EAST has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

WEST adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

West

1♠

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

North

Pass

East

3♠

South

Pass

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

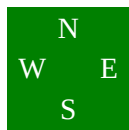
♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 9 4 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ K 5

♥ Q J 10 8 3

♦ K Q J

♣ 9 6 2



♠ 10 8 7 2
♥ A 6
♦ A 10 8
♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ K 9 5 2

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ A K

NORTH has a minimum 1♥ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of NORTH's ♥s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids 4♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ Q J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ J 8 4

♠ 5

♥ 10 8 4

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ 10 7 6 5 3

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♠ A J 10 8 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 9

♠ 6 3

♥ 9 7 6 3 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K Q 2

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

Pass

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

EAST has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

WEST has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

EAST now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠.

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

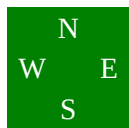
♠ K 8
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 10 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3



♠ Q
♥ K J 8 4
♦ Q J 10 6 2
♣ Q 7 2

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

SOUTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

NORTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So North should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 8 7
♥ 10 9 8 6 3
♦ A 6 2
♣ A 8

♠ Q 5 2

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 10 7 4

♣ J 10 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4

♥ A K 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ K 9 6 2

♠ K J 10 6 3

♥ Q J

♦ 9 8 5

♣ Q 7 3

West

1♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

North

Pass

East

4♥

South

WEST has 13 points so he must open. He has five ♥s so he should open 1♥.

EAST, with 14 points and four ♥s knows there are enough points for a game contract and at least nine ♥s between the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so EAST bids 4♥.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 7 3

♥ 10 2

♦ 9 6 3

♣ 10 9 5 3

♠ K 9

♥ A K J 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 7 6



♠ J 6 5 4

♥ 9 7

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ J 8 4

♠ Q 8 2

♥ Q 8 4 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ K Q 2

NORTH has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3♥.

NORTH is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows SOUTH has 12 points at most, so she should take the safe position and just bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Board 18

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5

♠ 10

♥ A 8 6 4

♦ K J 9 3

♣ Q 10 8 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J 10 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

♠ K

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A K J 4 3 2

West

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

North

Pass

East

1♠

South

Pass

WEST passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

EAST naturally opens 1♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

WEST might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4♠.

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 4
♥ 8 6 4 3
♦ J 7 5 2
♣ A 8 4

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ 8 6

♣ Q 7 6 3



♠ 6

♥ A J 10 9

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ J 10 9 5

♠ A Q 9 7 5 3

♥ Q 7

♦ A K 3

♣ K 2

SOUTH has 20 points, counting two extra for the fifth and sixth ♠s. Naturally she opens 1 ♠.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. He has four of partner's ♠s so he responds 2 ♠.

SOUTH KNOWS that $6 + 20 = 26$, so she GOES to 4 ♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

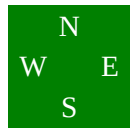
♠ A 7 4
♥ A J 8 7 2
♦ K Q J
♣ A 3

♠ Q 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K Q J 8 5



♠ J 8

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 10 9 3 2

♥ 10 9

♦ A 10 4

♣ 9 7 2

West

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

North

Pass

East

2♥

South

Pass

WEST has 20 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♥ rather than 2NT.

EAST barely has enough points for a response, but she does have four ♥s. So she responds 2♥.

WEST adds EAST's 6 to his 20 and bids the game, 4♥.

Board 21

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 5 4 2
♥ J 10
♦ A 10 9 6 5
♣ A J

♠ A
♥ K Q 9 8 7 4 2
♦ K Q
♣ K 4 2



♠ K Q 9 7
♥ A 5
♦ 7 2
♣ Q 10 9 6 3

♠ J 8 6 3
♥ 6 3
♦ J 8 4 3
♣ 8 7 5

West

North

East

South

1♥

All Pass

1♥ by North

NORTH has 20 points because she gets to add one point each for her fifth, sixth and seventh ♥s. So she opens 1♥.

SOUTH, with just 2 points, would have passed almost anything NORTH bid. Certainly he passes the 1♥ bid.

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 4 2
 ♥ 9 7 6
 ♦ Q J
 ♣ A K 7 2

♠ 9 3

♥ 8 4 3

♦ A 9 6 5 4

♣ J 10 6



♠ K Q 10 6 5

♥ K Q 2

♦ K 8 7

♣ 8 3

♠ A 7

♥ A J 10 5

♦ 10 3 2

♣ Q 9 5 4

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

EAST has 14 points so he opens one of his 5-card Major suit, 1 ♠.

WEST has some good ♣s, but with four of partner's Major she doesn't bother bidding anything else. Since she has 11 points she jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

EAST is very close to passing. He now gets to add a point for his doubleton ♣ which takes him up to 15 points. So he has enough to bid 4 ♠.

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6

♥ Q 4 3

♦ 10 9 7 6

♣ A J 9 8

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ K J 2

♦ A 5

♣ K 7 4 2



♠ A 4

♥ 10 7 6 5

♦ 8 4 3 2

♣ Q 10 3

♠ K J 8 7 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ K Q J

♣ 6 5

SOUTH has a normal opening bid of 1 ♠.

NORTH has a Limit Raise in ♠s, 11 points and 4 ♠s. He responds 3 ♠

SOUTH figures that 15 points is enough for game with partner showing 11/12. She bids 4 ♠.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Board 24

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 6 4 2

♦ A 3

♣ 4 2

♠ J 7 2

♥ 10 9

♦ K Q J 8 4

♣ A 10 3



♠ 5 4 3

♥ K 5 3

♦ 10 6 5

♣ Q J 8 5

♠ K Q 10 9 8

♥ J

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 9 7 6

EAST has 6 points and wouldn't dream of opening.

WEST has 17 points, counting three extra length points, so she opens 1♥.

EAST does have enough to raise to 2♥.

WEST makes one more try, inviting with a 3♥ bid but EAST just passes.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by West